



Brand Guidelines

A scientific gateway to the alpine world. Visual standards for the ALPFOR identity — credibility, discovery, and stewardship of mountain ecosystems through restrained design, strong typography, and exceptional alpine imagery.

Contents & Brand Statement

01	Brand Positioning	PG 03
02	Logo Usage	PG 04
03	Primary Colour	PG 05
04	Secondary & Accent	PG 06
05	Semantic Colour	PG 07
06	Typography	PG 08
07	Type Scale	PG 09
08	Layout & Spacing	PG 10
09	Buttons	PG 11
10	Cards	PG 12
11	Data Visualisation	PG 13
12	Photography	PG 14
13	Illustration	PG 15
14	Accessibility	PG 16
15	Design Tokens	PG 17

BRAND STATEMENT

ALPFOR is a scientific gateway to the alpine world.

It should feel like a respected research institution — evidence-based, trustworthy, and connected to nature without ever reading as eco-marketing.

This document modernises the ALPFOR identity while preserving its scientific credibility, alpine character, and connection to biodiversity research. It is the single reference for the website redesign and all supporting digital surfaces.

Maintained by the ALPFOR design team · Questions to brand@alpfor.org

How ALPFOR should feel

ALPFOR occupies the space between the rigour of a research institution and the wonder of the high alpine. Every design decision should reinforce that combination.

Brand attributes

Scientific

Credible

Alpine

Precise

Sustainable

Educational

Timeless

Brand personality

- **A respected research institution**
The tone of a university lab or scientific society.
- **A gateway to alpine ecosystems**
An invitation into high-mountain environments.
- **Evidence-based and trustworthy**
Claims are grounded in data and fieldwork.
- **Connected to nature, never eco-marketing**
Authentic stewardship over green branding.

What ALPFOR is not

- ✗ Corporate consulting
- ✗ Tech startup
- ✗ Environmental activism
- ✗ Tourism marketing

Guiding principle

Let photography and typography lead.
Apply colour with restraint. Over-branding erodes the scientific credibility that defines ALPFOR.

The ALPFOR mark

The logo pairs a contour-drawn alpine research station with the ALPFOR wordmark. Give it room to breathe and use only the two approved colour treatments.



Minimum clear space

Maintain clear space equal to the height of the “A” in ALPFOR on every side of the mark.



Minimum sizes

CONTEXT	MIN. WIDTH
Website header	140 px
Mobile	110 px
Print	30 mm

Treatment rules

Use the white mark only on the alpine blue or on dark photographic areas with sufficient contrast. Never recolour, rotate, stretch, add effects to, or place the logo on a busy background.

Primary palette

Two colours carry the brand. Alpine Blue anchors structure and authority; Snow White provides the calm, generous space the identity depends on.

ALPFOR Blue

#003863

RGB 0, 56, 99

- Navigation
- Footer
- Headlines on light
- Buttons

Snow White

#FFFFFF

RGB 255, 255, 255

- Backgrounds
- Text on dark surfaces

Restraint is the rule

Most of any layout should be white and blue. Secondary and accent colours are seasoning — introduced deliberately, never decoratively.

Secondary & accent

Supporting hues drawn from glacier ice, forest ridges, and alpine flora. Accents appear sparingly — for a single call to action or one important statistic.

SECONDARY PALETTE



Glacier Blue #ACD2DB

Section backgrounds, infographics, hover states

RGB 172, 210, 219



Forest Ridge #354D4F

Subheadings, icons, data visualisations

RGB 53, 77, 79



Alpine Rock #A8A28E

Borders, cards, secondary UI elements

RGB 168, 162, 142

ACCENT PALETTE — USE SPARINGLY



Alpine Flower Yellow #D6C84A

Calls to action, highlights, key statistics

RGB 214, 200, 74



Moss Orange #D9822B

Alerts, featured content, interactive maps

RGB 217, 130, 43

Accent discipline

If a page has more than one accent moment, remove one. Yellow and orange earn attention precisely because they are rare.

Semantic colour

System colours communicate state in forms, alerts, and feedback. They are functional — kept distinct from the brand palette so meaning is never ambiguous.

Success #2F6B4F
Confirmed actions, positive states

Warning #C98A1A
Cautions, non-blocking issues

Error #A13C3C
Failures, destructive actions

Information#2D6FA
Neutral notices, tips

Monitoring station online
All sensors reporting normally.

Data sync delayed
Last update 6 hours ago.

Upload failed
Field dataset could not be saved.

Seasonal survey opens 1 June
Registration is now available.

IBM Plex Sans

One typeface family carries the entire identity. Its engineered, humanist forms feel precise and institutional without being cold — exactly the ALPFOR character.

PRIMARY — IBM PLEX SANS

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLM
abcdefghijklm 0123456789

Body, navigation, UI, forms, tables

Light 300
Regular 400
Medium 500
SemiBold 600

SECONDARY — IBM PLEX SANS CONDENSED

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNO
abcdefghijklmno 0123456789

Headlines, hero, research highlights, statistics

Medium 500
SemiBold 600
Bold 700

Monitoring biodiversity above the treeline

Condensed bold for the headline, regular sans for the supporting text — the core pairing used across the site.

Type scale

A clear hierarchy from hero headline to caption. Condensed weights handle large display sizes; regular Plex Sans takes over from H4 down for maximum readability.

ELEMENT	DESKTOP	MOBILE	STYLE
H1	64px	40px	Cond Bold
H2	48px	32px	Cond SemiBold
H3	36px	28px	Cond SemiBold
H4	28px	24px	Plex Medium
H5	22px	—px	Plex Medium
Body L	20px	—px	Plex Regular
Body	18px	18px	Plex Regular
Small	16px	16px	Plex Regular
Caption	14px	—px	Plex Light

Alpine
Ecosystems
Field research

Intro paragraph in Medium

Body copy is set in IBM Plex Sans Regular at a comfortable reading size with generous line height.

Caption — Plex Light, used for metadata and image credits

Grid & spacing

An 8-pixel rhythm governs all spacing. Three content widths handle everything from long-form research to immersive, photography-led hero sections.

Content widths

WIDTH	VALUE	USE
Reading	760px	Articles, publications
Standard	1200px	Most pages
Wide	1440px	Hero, photography



Reading · Standard · Wide

Spacing scale — 8px grid

xs	8px	
sm	16px	
md	24px	
lg	40px	
xl	64px	
xxl	96px	
xxxl	160px	

Border radius

Keep corners restrained. Avoid highly rounded interfaces — sharp, precise geometry reads as scientific.



Buttons

Two button styles cover nearly every need. Primary for the main action, secondary for everything alongside it. Padding is 12×24px with a 4px radius.

PRIMARY

View publication

View publication

Background	#003863
Text	#FFFFFF
Hover	#002A4A

SECONDARY

Learn more

Learn more

Background	transparent
Border	1px #003863
Hover bg	rgba(0,56,99,.05)

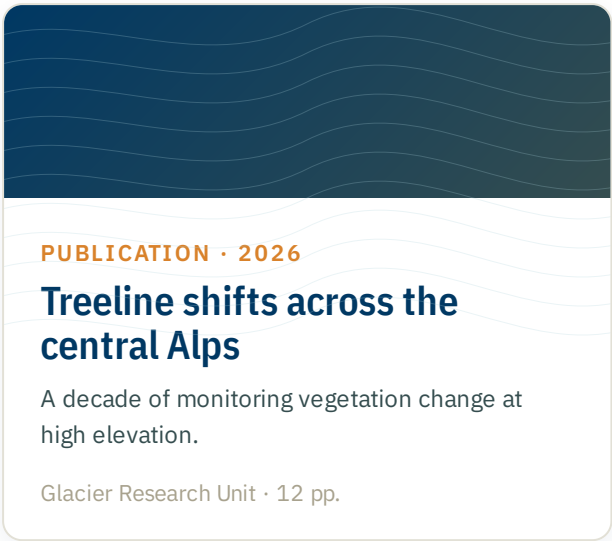
When an action must stand out

For a single, high-priority call to action, the Alpine Flower Yellow accent may back a button — reserved for one moment per page.

Cards

Cards organise research output and biodiversity records. White surfaces, a thin border, and a subtle shadow keep them quiet so content and imagery lead.

RESEARCH CARD



BIODIVERSITY CARD



Research card holds

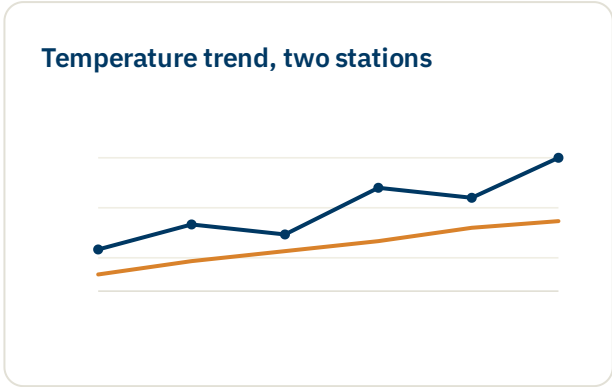
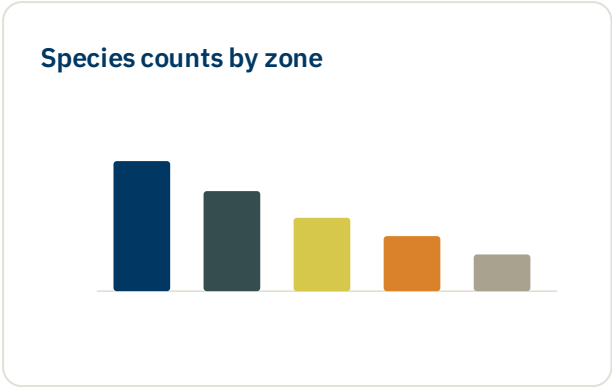
Featured image, strong headline, and publication metadata.

Biodiversity card holds

Species image, scientific and common names, habitat, observation metadata.

Charts

Charts communicate scientific rigour and clarity. A fixed, ordered series palette keeps every visualisation consistent and free of decorative noise.



Series order

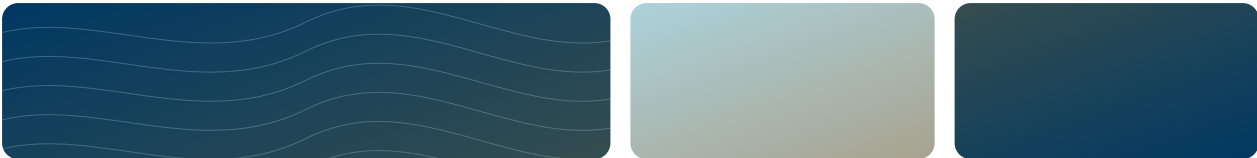
- Primary series
- Secondary series
- Accent series
- Highlight series
- Neutral series

Avoid

Rainbow palettes, excessive gradients, decorative chart effects, and unnecessary 3D. Data should read instantly.

Photography direction

Alpine landscape photography is ALPFOR’s strongest visual asset. Imagery should feel like documentation of real fieldwork — never staged or stock.



PREFERRED SUBJECTS

- + High alpine ecosystems
- + Scientific fieldwork
- + Biodiversity monitoring
- + Flora and fauna
- + Research stations
- + Geological formations
- + Snow and glacial environments

IMAGE STYLE

- + Natural lighting
- + Documentary photography
- + Minimal editing
- + Authentic field conditions
- + Wide alpine landscapes

AVOID

- ✗ Generic stock photography
- ✗ Artificial saturation
- ✗ Lifestyle imagery
- ✗ Corporate office photography
- ✗ Trendy social-media aesthetics

Illustration style

Illustration extends the scientific voice. Favour the visual language of field notebooks and survey maps — precise, informative, and earned.



PREFERRED

- + Topographic contour lines
- + Scientific diagrams
- + Habitat maps
- + Field sketches
- + Technical illustrations
- + Species identification graphics

AVOID

- × Cartoon illustrations
- × Corporate character illustrations
- × Decorative abstract artwork
- × Startup-style flat illustrations

Accessibility

Scientific credibility includes being legible to everyone. Test every colour combination against WCAG ratios before it ships.

Blue on white

8.6:1PASS

White on blue

8.6:1PASS

Forest on white

7.1:1PASS

Yellow on blue

6.0:1PASS

Minimum contrast

USAGE	MIN RATIO
Body text	4.5:1
Headlines	3:1
UI components	4.5:1

Always test

Blue on white · white on blue · Forest Ridge on white · Yellow on blue. Accent colours rarely carry text — when they must, verify the pairing meets the body-text ratio first.

Design tokens

The palette and type stack as code, ready to drop into the build. Tokens are the single source of truth — reference them, never hard-coded hex values.

COLOURS.JSON

```
{
  "alpfor-blue": "#003863",
  "glacier-blue": "#ACD2DB",
  "forest-ridge": "#354D4F",
  "alpine-rock": "#A8A28E",
  "flower-yellow": "#D6C84A",
  "moss-orange": "#D9822B",
  "white": "#FFFFFF"
}
```

TAILWIND.CONFIG.JS

```
export default {
  theme: { extend: {
    colors: { alpfor: {
      blue: "#003863",
      glacier: "#ACD2DB",
      forest: "#354D4F",
      rock: "#A8A28E",
      yellow: "#D6C84A",
      orange: "#D9822B"
    } },
    fontFamily: {
      sans: ["IBM Plex Sans"],
      heading: ["IBM Plex Sans Condensed"]
    }
  } }
}
```

Website design principles

DO

Let photography lead · strong typography ·
prioritise readability · restrained colour · generous
whitespace.

DON'T

Over-brand every element · flashy animation ·
trendy gradients · startup mimicry · accent
overuse.



Credibility, discovery, and stewardship of mountain ecosystems.

These guidelines keep the ALPFOR identity consistent across the website redesign and every surface that follows. When a decision isn't covered here, choose the more restrained, more scientific option.